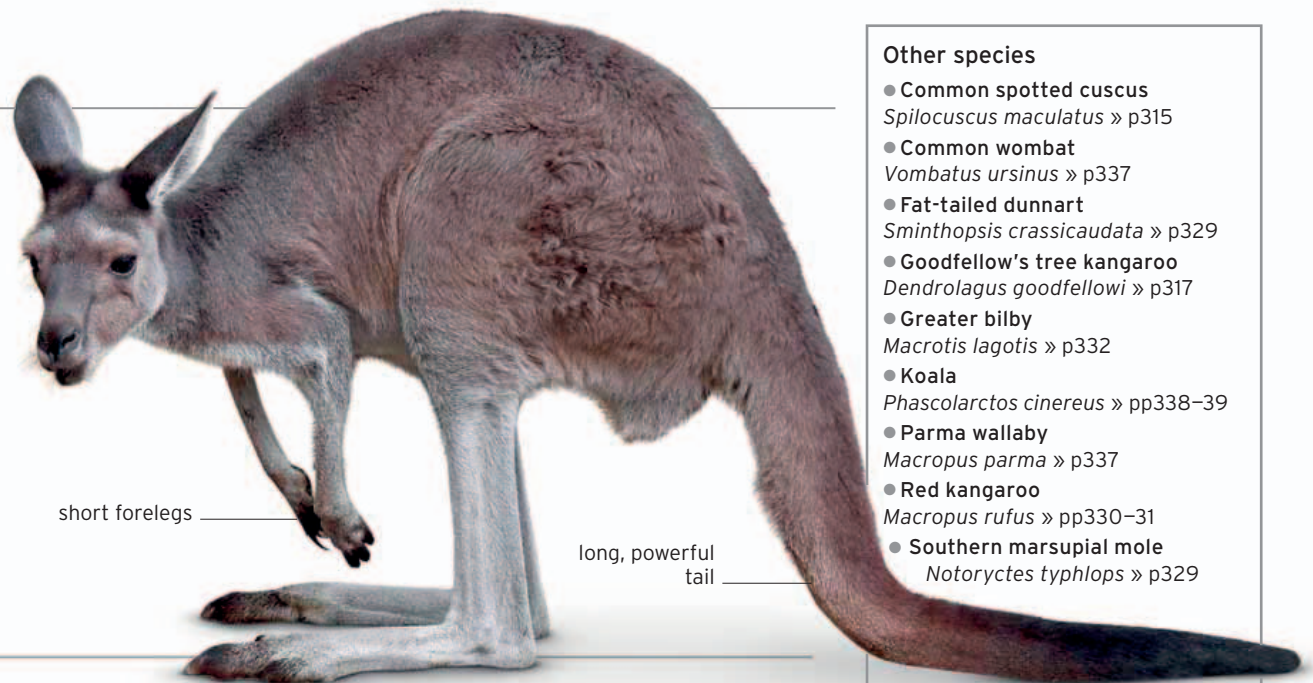


Western gray kangaroo

Macropus fuliginosus

- ↔ 3–5 ft (0.9–1.4 m)
- 📍 S. Australia
- ⊗ Locally common

One of the four largest kangaroos, this is also one of the most numerous. Widespread across southern Australia, it lives in groups of up to 15 in mixed habitats that offer shade in the day and good grazing at night. Like all kangaroos, the female nurtures her young in a pouch on her belly. Males are bigger than the females and fight over them by grappling, pushing, and kicking their rivals.



Other species

- Common spotted cuscus
Spilocuscus maculatus » p315
- Common wombat
Vombatus ursinus » p337
- Fat-tailed dunnart
Sminthopsis crassicaudata » p329
- Goodfellow's tree kangaroo
Dendrolagus goodfellowi » p317
- Greater bilby
Macrotis lagotis » p332
- Koala
Phascolarctos cinereus » pp338–39
- Parma wallaby
Macropus parma » p337
- Red kangaroo
Macropus rufus » pp330–31
- Southern marsupial mole
Notoryctes typhlops » p329



Quokka

Setonix brachyurus

- ↔ 16–22 in (40–54 cm)
- 📍 SW. Australia
- ⊗ Vulnerable

The quokka is a miniature kangaroo with a compact body the size of a domestic cat. Like other kangaroos, it hops on its hindlegs when moving

fast, but it can also climb into shrubs to reach juicy leaves and fruit. It feeds by night in swamps and woodland in southwestern Australia, but is now numerous only on a few islands such as Rottnest Island near Perth.

- Spectacled hare wallaby
Lagorchestes conspicillatus » p321
- Sugar glider
Petaurus breviceps » p316
- Tasmanian devil
Sarcophilus harrisii » p340
- Tiger quoll
Dasyurus maculatus » p341

Sengis

Order Macroscelidea

Karoo rock sengi

Elephantulus pilicaudus

- ↔ 4–6 in (10.5–14.5 cm)
- 📍 South Africa
- ⊗ Not known

The Karoo rock sengi is one of the elephant shrews—small mammals with very long snouts, which they use to probe the ground for prey such as earthworms and insects. This species is restricted to the semidesert Karoo region of South Africa, living on the boulder-strewn slopes of rocky mountains. Until 2008, it was thought to be a local race of the very similar but more widespread Cape sengi.

Other species

- Rufous sengi
Elephantulus rufescens » p182

Tenrecs and golden moles

Order Afrosoricida

Common tenrec

Tenrec ecaudatus

- ↔ 10–16 in (26–39 cm)
- 📍 Madagascar
- ⊗ Locally common

Resembling a large shrew but with sharp spines among its coarse gray fur, this is the biggest of about 30 species of tenrecs that are mainly native to Madagascar. It lives in a variety of habitats ranging from virgin forest to urban yards, using its long, mobile snout to root for insects, worms, and similar animals. It may also hunt small vertebrates such as frogs and mice. If threatened, the tenrec squeals, bristles up the spines on its neck into a crest, jumps and bucks, and readily bites. It shelters by day in a nest of grass and leaves under a log, rock, or bush.

Cape golden mole

Chrysochloris asiatica

- ↔ 4–6 in (9–14 cm)
- 📍 Southern Africa
- ⊗ Locally common

Although it is not closely related to the true moles, the Cape golden mole is similarly adapted for tunneling below ground. Its short front limbs have stout claws for digging—two on each foot—and it has short, soft fur that allows movement in either direction below ground. It is quite blind and relies on its nose and sensitivity to vibrations to locate soil animals, which are its main prey.

Other species

- Greater hedgehog tenrec
Setifer setosus » p241

Aardvark

Order Tubulidentata

Aardvark

Orycteropus afer

- ↔ 5 ft (1.6 m)
- 📍 Sub-Saharan Africa
- ⊗ Common

With its piglike snout and digging skills, the solitary, nocturnal aardvark deserves its name, which means “earth-pig.” It feeds on ants and termites, scooping them up with its sticky tongue.

